

Durably Sustainability Scan - Methodology

Version v47 - recalibrated score methodology and claims-risk framework

This document explains how the Sustainability Scan assesses green and social claims, how the three scores are calculated, and how results should be interpreted. The scan is an indicative first-pass review tool, not a legal opinion or formal assurance statement.

1. Regulatory and methodological basis

- **EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825**: used as the primary lens for consumer-facing environmental claims, including generic environmental claims, sustainability labels, carbon-neutrality/offsetting wording, future environmental performance, comparative claims and legal requirements presented as distinctive benefits.
- **Green Claims Directive proposal**: not treated as fully in-force law, but used as a best-practice substantiation lens for clear scope, scientific basis, high-quality data, transparency, verification and accessible evidence.
- **EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015**: used for product, supplier, import/export, traceability, forced-labour and modern-slavery wording. Such claims require product/supplier traceability, forced-labour risk assessment, mitigation, remediation and withdrawal/customs response readiness.
- **CSRD/ESRS, OECD Guidelines, UNGPs, ILO, UNGC and GRI**: used to assess whether broader social, labour, human-rights, customer and supply-chain claims are specific, balanced and evidence-based.

2. What the scan analyses

Layer	What is checked	Examples
Claim wording	Broad, generic, absolute, future, comparative or label/icon-based sustainability wording.	green, eco, sustainable, carbon neutral, responsible, ethical, all suppliers, forced-labour free.
Evidence gap	Missing scope, methodology, reporting period, KPIs, limitations, verification, grievance/remedy, supplier coverage or traceability.	No baseline, no GHG scopes, no audit coverage, no supplier tiers, no assurance basis.
External public-source signals	External stakeholder, regulator, legal, NGO or credible media signals that may contradict or qualify company claims. Company-owned reports are excluded from this layer.	greenwashing complaints, labour-rights allegations, regulator decisions, lawsuits, strikes, NGO reports.
Sector and channel sensitivity	Sector exposure and whether the scanned material is consumer-facing, investor reporting, internal/governance or mixed.	Retail, fashion, food, energy, chemicals and transport carry higher baseline exposure for certain claims.
Visual/icon cues	HTML image alt text, titles, filenames, classes and IDs are scanned for label/badge/icon signals.	leaf, planet, recycled, eco, climate, badge, certified, green label.

3. Score architecture

The scan reports three separate scores. Scores represent claim-risk signals, not ESG performance. A higher score means higher review priority.

Score	Meaning	Main drivers
Global score	Integrated sustainability claims-risk score. It combines the Green and Social scores with a bias toward the higher-risk dimension, while avoiding automatic equality where dimensions differ.	Green score, Social score, strongest dimension, overall balance.
Green score	Environmental/EmpCo claim-risk score. Highest relevance for consumer-facing commercial communications.	Generic green claims, carbon/offsetting, sustainability labels, future claims, comparisons, evidence gap, external green signals.
Social score	Social/forced-labour claim-risk score. Focuses on labour, human rights, suppliers, customers, inclusion and responsible sourcing.	Sensitive social wording, supplier/traceability/forced-labour signals, evidence gap, external social signals, sector exposure.

4. v47 calculation method

v47 removes the former fixed 48/100 plateau. In earlier versions, conservative caps could cause different companies to receive 48/100 for Global, Green and Social whenever certain thresholds were triggered. v47 keeps conservative caps, but makes them continuous so scores vary with the actual risk profile.

Component	Weight	Description
Claim wording risk	34%	Sensitivity of detected wording: generic, absolute, future, comparative, label/icon, climate-neutrality, ethical, responsible, supplier, forced-labour or traceability wording.
Evidence-gap risk	32%	Inverse of substantiation quality. Lower evidence produces higher evidence-gap risk. Evidence includes scope, methodology, KPIs, limits, verification, audit coverage, traceability and remediation.
External context risk	22%	Only retained company-specific external stakeholder signals count. Company-owned reports and policies are evidence sources, not external contradiction sources.
Sector/channel sensitivity	12%	Sector exposure and document channel modify the score but cannot by themselves create a high-risk result.
Modifiers	+/-	Direct EmpCo or Forced Labour Regulation indicators, number of high/medium claim types, repeated external signals and no-major-claim findings adjust the score.

5. Interpretation bands

Band	Interpretation
0-29 Low	No clear claim-risk signal or only limited wording that normally requires standard evidence discipline.
30-49 Medium-low	Potentially overbroad or weakly evidenced claim wording. Review wording and evidence file.
50-69 Medium / elevated	Material claim-risk signal. Requires legal/compliance, sustainability and marketing review before reuse.
70-89 High	Strong review signal, usually involving sensitive claim wording plus weak substantiation and regulatory or external-context relevance.
90-100 Very high	Reserved for exceptional cases with multiple severe indicators, strong evidence gaps and relevant external contradiction or direct regulatory sensitivity.

6. Green-claim modules

Module	Examples	Key evidence questions
Generic environmental claims	green, eco, natural, sustainable, environmentally friendly.	Is the claim specified clearly on the same medium? Is recognised excellent environmental performance relevant to the whole claim demonstrated?
Climate / offsetting claims	carbon neutral, climate neutral, net zero, climate positive.	Product or company level? Which GHG scopes? Actual reductions vs offsets? Baseline, residual emissions, verification?
Labels, badges and icons	eco choice, green certified, leaf/planet/recycled badge.	Independent scheme or self-declared? Criteria, audit basis, validity period, scheme owner?
Future environmental performance	we will be net zero by 2030, climate positive roadmap.	Public implementation plan, milestones, resources, governance, verification and progress reporting?
Comparative claims	greener than, lower impact, better for the planet.	Comparator, equivalent basis, methodology, data source, update process?

7. Social and forced-labour modules

Module	Examples	Key evidence questions
Human rights / labour rights	human rights, decent work, living wage, child labour, worker welfare.	Salient-risk assessment, due diligence, grievance channels, remedy, tracking of outcomes?
Supplier / responsible sourcing	responsible sourcing, ethical sourcing, all suppliers audited, traceable.	Supplier tiers, coverage, audit quality, worker voice, corrective-action closure, remediation?
Forced labour / product claims	forced-labour free, modern-slavery free, supplier traceability, import controls.	Product/supplier traceability, risk assessment by product/geography, mitigation, remediation, withdrawal/customs response?
Diversity, inclusion and customer fairness	inclusive, fair treatment, accessible for all, vulnerable customers.	Workforce/customer outcome data, complaint/remedy process, baselines, targets and progress?

8. Limitations and governance use

- The scan is an indicative first-pass screening tool. It does not establish greenwashing, social washing or legal non-compliance.
- PDF extraction is best effort for text-based PDFs. Image-only PDFs and visual layouts may require manual review.
- External search quality depends on configured search providers and available snippets. All external signals must be manually verified.
- The output should feed a sustainability claims register with owner, approved wording, evidence file, source URL/document, review date and legal/compliance sign-off status.